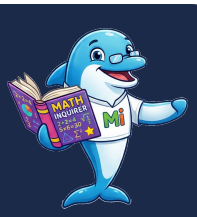
TUTOR NOTES • LEVEL 1 • TERM 3 • MI'S CHALLENGE QUEST

Mi's Challenge Quest



8 gates, one from each lesson of the term, all at Start here level, plus one optional secret cave item. 20 minutes after the break, played in pairs or as a group quest with Mi, working on private paper. It is a game: no score or mark is shown to the child, no ranking, no visible timer. You keep private notes only. For the tutor: do not hand these notes to families.

Where it sits. Lesson 30 (the last lesson of the term), minutes 35 to 55, the part Mi's Challenge Quest, straight after the brain break; or at the make-up slot. Owner decisions of 22 Oct 2026: the end-of-term slot is a game with Mi, not a test. The group plays it in pairs (a child and a quest partner) or as a group quest with Mi, on private paper. No score or mark is shown to the child, there is no ranking and no visible timer. The tutor keeps private notes only, for one line to each grown-up and for advice for next term's group. It keeps the 20-minute slot after the break and the question quality: 8 short gates and one optional secret cave item, all at Start here level. Lessons 21 and 22 share gate 1 and Lessons 25 and 26 share gate 4, so every lesson of the term is still visited. Gate 7 asks the child to check a sum a friend wrote, which is the claim-testing the term line talks about. The secret cave joins two ideas the group has met (money and listing) in an unseen way. A middle child needs about 17 minutes of reading aloud and quiet work; a slower child may use a few minutes of the workbook time to finish. The quest sits straight after the brain break so children are fresh. The Quest Log carries the Term 3 pictures (a clock, coins, price tags, a grid, a stick pattern and a calendar). Time is written as digits with am or pm; money with the cent sign.

1. The gates at a glance

Gate	From	Area (tutor label)	What it uses (Start here level)	Answer
1	L21, 22	Time	Read a clock to 5 minutes, and am or pm (Lessons 21 and 22)	**4:35; am**
2	L23	Time	Half an hour and one hour later (Lesson 23)	**3:00; 6:30**
3	L24	Money	Count coins and find the change (Lesson 24)	**95; 3**
4	L25, 26	Money	Compare two prices, and two items that cost exactly $10 (Lessons 25 and 26)	**ruler; $3; $4 and $6**
5	L27	Number patterns; logic	A grid puzzle: one of each shape in every row and column (Lesson 27)	**triangle**
6	L28	Number patterns; logic	A growing stick pattern (Lesson 28)	**9; 11**
7	L29	Process skills; Addition and Subtraction	Check a sum a friend wrote (Lesson 29)	**No; 87**
8	L30	Process skills; Addition and Subtraction	Days later and a week on the month page (Lesson 30)	**Monday; 10**
Secret cave	unseen	unseen puzzle	Exactly $14 with $2 notes and $5 notes (money and listing joined) (optional)	**Seven $2 notes, or two $2 notes and two $5 notes; yes, there are 2 ways**

The area labels are for the tutor only and never appear on a child or parent page. Each gate is a fresh example of the Start here idea of its lesson (numbers chosen so that they do not repeat a lesson page), so a child who followed the lesson can open it. Before first use, read each gate against what the lesson actually taught.

2. Playing it: before and during

1. A week before: send the grown-up note (L30_Quest_Parent_Note.pdf) and the Quest Log (L30_Quest_Log.pdf, 4 pages) with the lesson materials. Families print the Quest Log at 100%, keep it closed in an envelope and find a quest partner (a grown-up or a brother or sister). A family with no printer tells you: arrange another way (for example the make-up slot).
2. Tell the group in the opening and at slide s-quest1: this is Mi's Challenge Quest, a game with Mi. Everyone works on their own paper with a quest partner beside them. It is not a race, a gate may be skipped, and nothing is shown to the group.
3. Start at minute 35 (straight after the brain break) and finish by minute 55. Children open the Quest Log only when you say. The paper lies flat on the table and is never held up. The quest partner may talk about how to start and ask 'how do you know?', but does not give answers. Cameras may be on or off. Use your own watch out of sight of the camera: no clock, countdown or timer is ever shown to the children.

4. Read each page aloud, one gate at a time (the script has the words), then leave quiet working time: about 2.5 minutes for page 1, 3 for page 2, 3 for page 3 and 2 for page 4. After each page say that the gates are open and Mi swims on, whatever the answers. Say nothing about right or wrong, and read no answers. A middle child needs about 17 minutes in all; a slower child may finish in the first minutes of the workbook.
5. Allowed: fingers, counters and talk with the quest partner. Not allowed: a calculator, a grown-up giving answers, looking at the workbook. A child who finishes early turns the Quest Log over and draws quietly.
6. After page 2, take a one-minute stretch (stand, shake out, sip water). After page 4, show slide s-quest2. Do not collect or look at any Quest Log. While children work, notice (do not write on the shared screen) how they start: counters, drawing, strip, talking to the partner.

3. After the lesson: photos and your private notes

1. Same day: the grown-up takes ONE clear photo of each of the 4 pages (page flat, taken straight from above, the whole page in view, and the name on each page) and sends them to the program's business WhatsApp, +65 9880 5962, and to no other number. Never to a child, never to a personal phone, never into the class chat.
2. Within 3 days: open the photos only on the business WhatsApp (never on a personal phone) and write your private notes (section 5) for each child, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Section 4 shows what each answer tells you; accept 5 or 5th for gate 1 part a, and either order of 3 and 5 in gate 4. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is added up and no order of children is made. Nothing about the quest goes back to the child or the group except thanks.
3. Write ONE line for each grown-up from your notes (section 7): what we saw, in plain words, and one small next step if it helps. It is sent to the parent only. No marks, no x out of 8, no ranking, no comparison with other children, no prediction.
4. Fill in the group advice sheet (section 6): what several children were still working on, with no names, and what you will do in the first lessons of next term. It is kept for next term's tutor and is never shown to families.
5. Once the line is sent, save the photos to the program's private file store and delete them from the business WhatsApp chat. The program keeps the photos for 90 days after the program ends, then deletes them, as the privacy notice says. Delete each child's notes sheet when the line is sent (keep only the line in the family file, and the group advice sheet). Never forward the photos or save them to a personal phone or any other device.
6. At the start of next term say to the whole group: thank you for playing Mi's Challenge Quest; there is nothing to share and nothing to fear. Never name a child or an answer.

Privacy checklist

- Quest Logs are never held up to the camera and never read out.
- No answer is said aloud during or after the quest. Gates open for everyone, whatever the answers.
- No clock, countdown or timer is shown; nobody is told who finished first or last.
- Photos come to the program's business WhatsApp (+65 9880 5962) only; tutors never use a personal phone; photos are kept 90 days after the program ends, then deleted; the line goes to the parent only; no private message to any child.
- No score, no x out of 8, no ranking, no tally, no comparison between children, not even in your own notes.
- The recording captures the tutor, the shared screen and any voice that is not muted: the recording is paused for the whole quest (slides s-quest1 and s-quest2) and restarted for the workbook. The WhatsApp number is never on a slide.

Absent, late joiners, families who prefer not to, upset children

- A child who was away or whose family prefers another time: plays the quest at the make-up slot BEFORE watching the recording (the quest is not on the recording, so no gate is given away). It is a small group or a pair with Mi, with a parent beside the child on camera. The tutor never sits alone with one child on a private call.
- A child who joined late: the family may choose to leave out gates for lessons the child did not attend. Write nothing for those gates; if no gate of an area was taught, the line for the grown-up says nothing about that area.
- A family that does not want the quest: no problem. The child does the Lesson 30 work as usual and the line for the grown-up uses your own notes from the lessons only.
- A child who is upset or stuck: remind the group (open session) that every gate can be skipped and Mi swims round it. Do not single the child out. The grown-up may stop the quest at any time.
- A family with no printer: tell the family to say so a week before and arrange another way (for example the make-up slot, with the Quest Log sent to the family another way). Never ask a child about it in front of the group.

4. Answers and what to look for

Use these to understand what you see on camera and in the photos. Nothing is written on the child's paper, nothing is totalled and no gate is marked right or wrong in front of anyone. A child may write steps in any clear layout. Spelling and neatness do not matter.

Gate 1 (L21, 22) Look at the clock.
Answer: 4:35; am
(a) The time is __ . = 4:35; (b) Breakfast is at 7:00. Write am or pm: __ = am
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: The long hand is on the 7, which is 35 minutes. The short hand is just before the 5, so the hour is 4: 4:35. Breakfast is in the morning: am.
Watch for: (a) 7:20 or 5:35 (the two hands read the wrong way round).; (b) pm.

Gate 2 (L23) A film starts at 2:30. It lasts half an hour.
Answer: 3:00; 6:30
(a) The film ends at __ . = 3:00; (b) One hour after 5:30 is __ . = 6:30
A secure answer looks like: Both correct (3 or 3:00 is right for part a). **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: Half an hour after half past 2 is 3 o'clock. One hour after 5:30 is 6:30.
Watch for: (a) 2:60 or 2:00.; (b) 5:30 or 6:00.

Gate 3 (L24) Look at the coins.
Answer: 95; 3
(a) The coins make __ cents. = 95; (b) Mei pays $10 for a toy that costs $7. Her change is $__ . = 3
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 50 and 20 make 70, and 20 more is 90, and 5 more is 95 cents. Count up from 7 to 10: 3 dollars change.
Watch for: (a) 85 or 100 (a counting slip).; (b) 17 (adding) or 7.

Gate 4 (L25, 26) A pen costs $6 and a ruler costs $9. The tags say $4, $5 and $6 in part c.
Answer: ruler; $3; $4 and $6
(a) Which costs more? Write pen or ruler: __ = ruler; (b) How much more? $__ = 3; (c) Two tags cost exactly $10. They are $__ and $__ . = 4 and 6
A secure answer looks like: All correct (the two prices in either order). **Half way there:** Two of the three correct.
Worked: 9 is more than 6, so the ruler costs more. Count up from 6 to 9: $3 more. 4 and 6 make 10, and 5 and 5 would need two $5 tags.
Watch for: (a) pen.; (b) 15 (adding) or 9.; (c) $4 and $5 (without adding) or $5 and $6.

Gate 5 (L27) Every row and every column has a circle, a square and a triangle.
Answer: triangle
(a) The box with the ? mark has a __ . = triangle
A secure answer looks like: Triangle. **Half way there:** -
Worked: The middle row has a square and a circle, so it needs a triangle. The middle column has a square and a circle too. The answer is a triangle.
Watch for: Circle or square (a shape already in the row or column).

Gate 6 (L28) Triangles in a row use 3, 5 and 7 sticks.
Answer: 9; 11
(a) The next picture uses __ sticks. = 9; (b) 5 triangles use __ sticks. = 11
A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: Each new triangle adds 2 sticks: 3, 5, 7, 9, 11. 5 triangles use 11 sticks.
Watch for: (a) 8 (adding 1).; (b) 15 (5 times 3).

Gate 7 (L29) A child in another class writes 49 + 38 = 77.
Answer: No; 87
(a) Is the answer right? Circle Yes or No. (Yes / No) = No; (b) The right answer is __ . = 87
A secure answer looks like: No and 87. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.
Worked: 77 take away 38 is 39, not 49, so 77 is wrong. 9 and 8 make 17: 1 ten and 7 ones, so 40 and 30 and 10 and 7 make 87.
Watch for: (a) Yes (not checking).; (b) 77 again or 97.

Gate 8 (L30) Today is Friday. Look at the calendar. The yellow day is the 3rd.

Answer: Monday; 10

(a) Three days later it is __ . = Monday; (b) A week after the 3rd is the __ th. = 10

A secure answer looks like: Both correct. **Half way there:** One of the two correct.

Worked: Saturday is 1, Sunday is 2, Monday is 3. A week is 7 days: 3 and 7 make 10.

Watch for: (a) Sunday (counting Friday as day 1).; (b) 9 or 11.

Secret cave (optional) (unseen) Ali has lots of $2 notes and $5 notes. He pays exactly $14.

Answer: Seven $2 notes, or two $2 notes and two $5 notes; yes, there are 2 ways

(a) One way: __ two-dollar notes and __ five-dollar notes. = 7 and 0, or 2 and 2; (b) Is there another way? Circle Yes or No. (Yes / No) = Yes

A secure answer looks like: The answer is as above. **Half way there:** -

Worked: Seven $2 notes make 14. Two $5 notes make 10, and 2 two-dollar notes make 4, so 10 and 4 make 14. One $5 note leaves 9 and three $5 notes make 15, which do not work, so there are exactly 2 ways.

Watch for: A way that does not add to 14.; Saying there is only one way.

5. Tutor private notes (tutor only; one sheet per child; delete when the line is sent)

Child (first name only): ..... Date: ..... Quest partner: .....

Fill this in after the lesson, from the photos and what you saw on camera. Write what the child did and said in your own words. No ticks for right or wrong, no points, nothing added up. The gate numbers are only reminders of where to look.

Gate	From	What I saw (words used, counters or drawing, how the partner helped, anything the child said)
1	L21, 22	
2	L23	
3	L24	
4	L25, 26	
5	L27	
6	L28	
7	L29	
8	L30	
Cave	unseen	

Prompt	My notes
Something the child did well (a named strength, for example: drew a strip to find how many more marbles one child had)	
How they started: counters, drawing a strip, ten-frames, or in their head	
Where they paused or turned to their partner, and what helped	
One next step for home (small and concrete)	
Did they try the secret cave? (a neutral note only)	

The one line for the grown-up (section 7), written from these notes:

.....

.....

6. Group advice for next term (tutor only; one sheet per class; no names)

When all the notes are written, look across them without names. Write what several children were still working on and how you will use the first two lessons of next term (a warm-up, a picture, a game). This page never goes to families.

Area	What several children were still working on (no names)	What I will do in the first two lessons of next term
Time: clocks and the calendar Lessons 21 to 30: reading a clock to 5 minutes, am and pm, half an hour and one hour later, and counting on days and weeks on a calendar		
Money: coins, change and prices Lessons 24 to 26: counting coins, finding the change, comparing two prices and finding two items that cost an exact amount		
Puzzles and patterns Lessons 27 to 28: a grid with one of each shape in every row and column, and a growing pattern of sticks		
Checking and explaining Lessons 29 to 29: checking a sum a friend wrote and finding the right answer		

Prompt	My notes
Gates or ideas where several children paused (no names)	
A warm-up or game to bring back in the first lesson of next term	
What worked well about the quest as a game, to keep next time	

7. The one line for the grown-up: what we saw

Mi's Challenge Quest: [Name]
In Mi's Challenge Quest, [Name] [one specific thing you saw, in plain words]. [Optional: one small next step at home.]

One or two sentences at most. Say what the child did (drew a strip, shared equally, explained a step), not how many answers were right. Use the lines below as patterns and always add your own detail from your notes.

Area (parent wording)	Things you might have seen (pick the one your notes show; add the detail)	A next step that helps at home
Time: clocks and the calendar Lessons 21 to 30. We looked at reading a clock to 5 minutes, am and pm, half an hour and one hour later, and counting on days and weeks on a calendar.	• [Name] read a clock to 5 minutes and said am or pm. • [Name] found the time half an hour and one hour later, with a clock or a number line. • [Name] counted on from tomorrow to find the day 3 days later.	• Say the time on a real clock at different times of the day, and ask am or pm. • Look at a calendar and ask: what day is it 3 days later?
Money: coins, change and prices Lessons 24 to 26. We looked at counting coins, finding the change, comparing two prices and finding two items that cost an exact amount.	• [Name] counted coins by adding in tens and fives. • [Name] found the change by counting up, and found how much more one price was than another. • [Name] found two items that cost exactly an amount.	• Play shop with real things and play money; count the change up. • Pick two prices from a leaflet and ask how much more one costs.
Puzzles and patterns Lessons 27 to 28. We looked at a grid with one of each shape in every row and column, and a growing pattern of sticks.	• [Name] filled a grid by saying which shapes the row and the column already had. • [Name] found the next picture of a stick pattern and counted how many sticks were added each time.	• Make a pattern of three kinds of small things on a 3 by 3 grid with one of each in every row. • Build triangles in a row with paper strips and count the sticks.
Checking and explaining Lesson 29. We looked at checking a sum a friend wrote and finding the right answer.	• [Name] checked a sum by adding back and found the right answer.	• Write a sum with one mistake and ask your child to check it a different way.

A filled example (fictional child, Mei)

Mi's Challenge Quest: Mei
In Mi's Challenge Quest, Mei drew a strip to find how many more marbles one child had, and shared 16 stickers equally among 4 friends. A good next step: share real counters onto plates at home to find how many in each.

This line describes Mei's own thinking in the game. It does not compare children.

Words to avoid in the line: score, mark, out of, rank, top, below average, behind, ahead of, pass, fail, predicted, ready for. No claim about school exams, GEP or any contest, and no mention of other children. The line goes to the parent only. If the child skipped the secret cave or a gate, say nothing about it. If the child tried the secret cave, you may add: "[Name] also had a go at the secret cave."